

# PRESCRIBE RATIONALLY



Scan QR code to download Medsafety App to report medication adverse events.

## Assess the patient needing a prescription

| Assess                 | Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagnosis              | Confirm the patient's diagnosis, that the medication is necessary and that its benefits outweigh the risks.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Other conditions       | If necessary adjust the dose (e.g. simvastatin, hydrochlorothiazide in liver disease; tenofovir in kidney disease) or change medication (e.g. avoid ibuprofen in hypertension, asthma).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Other medications      | Check all medication (prescribed, over-the-counter, herbal) is necessary and for possible interactions especially if on hormonal contraceptive or treatment for TB, HIV, epilepsy.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Allergies              | If known allergy or previous bad reaction to medication, record in patient's notes and discuss alternative with doctor.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Age                    | If > 65 years consider lowering the dose or frequency of medication. Discuss with doctor if patient on amitriptyline, theophylline, ibuprofen, amlodipine or fluoxetine or is using > 5 medications.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Pregnant/breastfeeding | If pregnant or breastfeeding check if the medication is safe. Ensure patient receives routine antenatal care ➔ 161.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Response to treatment  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>If the patient's condition does not improve, first exclude poor adherence, then consider changing the treatment or an alternative diagnosis.</li> <li>Check for side effects and report medication reactions via: the MedSafety App (scan the QR code for download) or the reporting website <a href="https://primaryreporting.who-umc.org/ZA">https://primaryreporting.who-umc.org/ZA</a> or using an Adverse reporting form<sup>1</sup>. Email this to <a href="mailto:adr@sahpra.org.za">adr@sahpra.org.za</a>.</li> </ul> |

## Advise the patient needing a prescription

- Explain to the patient when and how to take the medication and what to do if side effects occur. Ask the patient to repeat your explanation to ensure s/he understands how to take the medication.
- Ensure patient knows the generic name of all his/her medication and advise to ask prescriber/pharmacist if s/he does not understand a change to regular medication.
- Educate the patient on the importance of adherence and that not adhering to medication may lead to relapse or worsening of the condition and in some instances, resistance to the medication.
- Over-the counter medications and herbal treatments may interfere with prescribed medication. Encourage patient to discuss with prescriber before using them.

## Treat the patient needing a prescription

- Ensure that the appropriate prescriber writes the prescription: **orange-highlighted** medications may be prescribed by a doctor or a nurse according to his/her scope of practice. **Purple-highlighted** medications may be initiated by a doctor and continued by a nurse according to his/her scope of practice. **Blue-highlighted** medications may be prescribed by a doctor only.
- Consult the South African Medicines Formulary (SAMF) or MIC helpline (021) 406 6829 if unsure about your medicine choice and dosing, side-effects or drug interactions.
- If medications listed in APC are not available, check Therapeutic Class list<sup>2</sup> and local formulary to identify specific medicine that has been approved for use in your facility.
- Once patient stable on chronic medication and agrees to be registered for Central Chronic Medicines Dispensing and Distribution (CCMDD) programme, help patient select a pick up point (PuP). Then create 6-month repeat prescription (see below). Write neatly. Patient will collect first supply at facility, then next 5 months from chosen PuP. Patient to return to facility every 6 months.

| PRESCRIPTION               |  |                                                 |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|----------------------------|--|-------------------------------------------------|--|------------------|--|--------|--|--------|--|--------|--|--------|--|--------|--|
| PATIENT'S NAME AND SURNAME |  |                                                 |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
| ID                         |  | Age                                             |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
| ALLERGIES                  |  |                                                 |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
| DATE                       |  | DETAILS OF PRESCRIPTION                         |  | REPEATS          |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|                            |  | Print the name of the drugs in the blocks below |  | 1 of 6 (INITIAL) |  | 2 of 6 |  | 3 of 6 |  | 4 of 6 |  | 5 of 6 |  | 6 of 6 |  |
|                            |  | NOTE ONE ITEM PER BOX                           |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|                            |  | Date                                            |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|                            |  | Quantity                                        |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|                            |  | Batch No                                        |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|                            |  | Dispenser Signature                             |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|                            |  | Print Name                                      |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |
|                            |  | Prescriber name, signature & qualifications     |  |                  |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |        |  |

Patient's name and surname

Prescription date

Generic name of medication in full  
Dose, strength, frequency  
Number of repeats  
(maximum for 6 months)

Prescriber's name, qualifications and signature

Patient's age

Patient's ID or passport number

Patient's allergies

Number of repeats (maximum for 6 months)  
Delete those boxes where repeat not needed

Date of issue

Name and signature of dispenser

<sup>1</sup>Adverse drug reaction report forms available from clinic pharmacy or may be accessed via website: [www.sahpra.org.za](http://www.sahpra.org.za). <sup>2</sup> Primary Health Care Essential Medicines List, 2020 edition: Therapeutic classes and members list can be accessed via: <https://www.knowledgehub.org.za/library/primary-health-care-phc-essential-medicines-list-eml-2020>